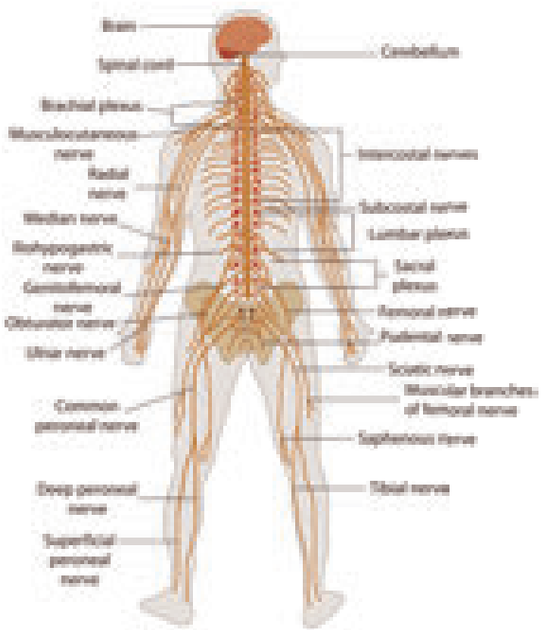
2. The support of the human body which gives it its form and stability
3. Body movement
4. Control of metabolic functions like the calcium and calcium storage as well as iron metabolism and iron storage in the bone marrow
5. Hematopoiesis, the production of red blood cells in the bone marrow of bones.

1.5 Nervous System

The nervous system is the most complex of all the systems which coordinates controls and enables all body functions like movement, thinking, autonomic, or automatic, reflexes and sensory perception. The nervous system sends messages to all parts of the body and receives it. For example, when a person touches fire, the message is sent to the brain which interprets and sends a message to the person's finger to suddenly remove it.

The Parts of the Nervous System

- The central nervous system
- The peripheral nervous system



Nervous System

The parts of the central nervous system are the

- Brain
- Spinal cord

The Brain

The brain is placed inside a skull or cranium which protects it. The brain consists of three major parts, two hemispheres (right and left hemisphere) and meninges, the protective membrane.

The meninges have three layers (PAD)

P-Pia mater (inner)

A-Arachnoid (middle)

D-Dura mater (outer).

The spinal cord is covered with meninges. The subarachnoid space (space between the arachnoid layer and the pia mater) contains the cerebrospinal fluid.

Cerebrospinal fluid (CSF)

CSF fluid is a clear, colorless body fluid found in the brain and spinal cord. It is about 125ml of CSF at any one time and about 500ml is generated everyday.

CSF acts as a cushion or buffer for the brain, providing basic mechanical and immunological protection to the brain inside the skull.

Note: Both the brain and the spinal cord are comprised of gray matter and white matter. Gray matter plays a higher role in the central nervous system's functioning than the white matter. The white matter consists of lesser cells than the gray matter.

The brain is also divided into three major areas

- Cerebrum
- Cerebellum
- Brain stem

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